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TUESDAY

JUNE 9, 2026
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SHARJAH FIREFIGHTERS SAVE NEWBORN

In a dramatic pre-dawn rescue operation, firefighters from the Sharjah Civil Defence Authority saved a newborn baby trapped inside a smoke-filled apartment after a fire broke out in a residential building in Al Nasserya on Friday morning. The infant was safely reunited with her family after rescue teams battled dense smoke and rapidly escalating risks inside the second-floor apartment, where the fire originated from an air-conditioning unit. Thanks to the swift response and coordinated efforts of Civil Defence personnel, all occupants were evacuated safely and no injuries were reported.

SEE ALSO P2

Over 3,200 first-time home buyers generate Dh5 billion

A total of 22 builders now offer homes in expanded initiative

DUBAI

BY NIVETHA DAYANAND
Assistant Business Editor

Dubai's First Time Home Buyer Programme has helped more than 3,200 residents purchase their first home and generated over Dh5 billion in residential transactions since its launch in July 2025, the Government Media Office reports.

The scheme, run by the Dubai Land Department (DLD) with the Dubai Department of Economy and Tourism (DET), is open to all UAE residents aged 18 and above who do not yet own a freehold home in the emirate.

In its latest phase, nine new developers joined the programme, lifting the total to 22 participating builders. The newly participating developers include 4Direction Developments, Arada, Dubai World

Trade Centre, IRTG Group, Manam, Qube Development, Reportage Properties, SAMANA Developers, and Sky View Real Estate. Binghatti Holding was recognised by DET and DLD for achieving the highest number of units sold under the programme since its launch.

More housing options

This expansion broadens housing options across locations, price points, and property types, giving buyers more choice and flexibility.

Five local banks are offering financing support to eligible buyers, helping bridge the gap between aspiration and ownership.

Officials say the programme reflects Dubai's commitment to making homeownership more attainable and strengthening long-term community stability. Residents who haven't signed up can register through the Dubai Land Department website or the Dubai REST app to explore available homes and access programme benefits.

7 killed, 9 injured in deadly crash on Emirates Road

Dubai Police issue warning after collision caused by stationary truck in traffic lane

DUBAI

BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

Seven people died and nine others were injured, many of them Indians, when a minibus collided with a truck that had stopped in the middle of the road on Emirates Road in Dubai.

"Preliminary investigations indicate that the truck had stopped suddenly in the middle of the road due to a technical malfunction. The bus driver, reportedly failing to pay attention and maintain a safe distance, collided with the truck from behind. The accident resulted in seven fatalities and nine injuries, including five serious and four moderate injuries. All injured were transported to hospital for treatment," said Brigadier Juma Salem Bin

IRAN, ISRAEL HALT ATTACKS BUT TENSIONS REMAIN HIGH

Warn of response if hostilities resume

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Fresh missile and drone exchanges between Iran and Israel overnight raised fears of a return to full-scale war, threatening to unravel a fragile ceasefire that has largely held since April and jeopardising diplomatic efforts aimed at securing a lasting peace agreement.

The latest flare-up began after Israel struck Hezbollah-linked targets in Lebanon, prompting Iran to launch missiles at Israel in support of its ally. Israel responded with airstrikes on military and strategic targets inside Iran, marking the most serious escalation between the two sides since the US-brokered truce took effect on April 8.

By yesterday afternoon, however, both sides appeared to be stepping back from the brink.

Iran announced a suspension of its military operations but warned that any further Israeli "aggression and hostility", including attacks in southern Lebanon, would trigger "much more severe and crushing measures".

Backing off for now

Shortly afterwards, Israeli media reported that Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu had agreed to refrain from additional strikes on Iran for now following a request from US President Donald Trump.

Netanyahu later acknowledged the halt in fighting with Iran but vowed that Israel would respond "with force" to any future attacks, underscoring the fragile nature of the latest pause.



AFP

■ A missile fragment is lodged in the ground near Jericho after Iran fired a wave of missiles toward Israel yesterday.

Israeli Defence Minister Israel Katz also vowed to press ahead with military operations in Lebanon and warned that Beirut's southern suburbs would be targeted in response to attacks on northern Israel.

Iran responded by reiterating that its suspension of military operations was conditional. Tehran warned that any continued Israeli action in Lebanon could prompt a renewed response.

Iranian state media reported that flights at airports across the country had been suspended until further notice, while Israel announced that schools would remain closed today.

Despite the pause between Iran and Israel, hostilities continued on the Lebanese front. Lebanese state media reported Israeli strikes on several locations in southern Lebanon, including Al Zrariyah, Arabsalim and Kfar Tebnit. The Israeli military, meanwhile, said projectiles had been fired at its forces in southern Lebanon,

although no injuries were reported. The latest crisis has also raised concerns about the future of diplomacy. Washington has been working to transform the April ceasefire into a broader agreement aimed at ending the conflict and reducing tensions across the region.

Trump called on both sides to "immediately stop shooting" and insisted that recent violence should not derail ongoing negotiations with Tehran.

Pakistan urges restraint

Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif also urged restraint, warning that the latest escalation underscored the fragility of the ceasefire. "The recent surge in violence in the Middle East is a stark reminder of the dangers associated with a tenuous ceasefire," Sharif said on X.

He added that a diplomatic breakthrough remained within reach and appealed to all parties to "give peace a little more chance".

SEE ALSO P6, 7, 8, 10

WORLD

35 dead, over 200 injured as a 7.8 earthquake strikes the Philippines | P11

TELL ME WHY



Zhann Jochinke, COO, Property Monitor, shares how transparency and market intelligence are critical to sustaining the long-term growth of the UAE property market



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